IELTS Academic (Computer)

60-Day Self-Study Plan for Band 7

Self-study, 3 hours a day, with ChatGPT and Gemini as Speaking and Writing examiner. Use with the Excel workbook **IELTS_60_Day_Plan.xlsx**.

Item	Plan
Target	Overall 7.0 Academic, no skill below 6.5 (confirm each employer or regulator's per-skill rule for UK, Ireland, New Zealand)
Length	60 sessions, 15 Oct to 13 Dec 2026, about 180 hours
Exam	Book a computer-delivered slot for 14-20 Dec 2026, now, before slots fill
Main weak points	Typing answers in computer Listening; Speaking fluency (repeated words, stress)
Strength	Paper Listening is already strong, so the skill is there; only the screen habit is new
Full mock tests	8 (Sessions 1, 14, 21, 28, 35, 42, 49, 54)

How to use: each session lists what to do in each block and the resource code to use (codes and links in Section 4). Write 'Yes' in the Done column (or the Excel plan) after each session. If a day is missed, do not skip ahead: continue from the next session and drop one light day later. 'CAM Test N' counts through the Cambridge books in order: Book 15 Tests 1-4 = CAM Tests 1-4, Book 16 = 5-8, and so on to Book 20 (Tests 21-24).

Contents: 1 Daily session · 2 Computer test: what changes · 3 ChatGPT and Gemini as examiner · 4 Websites and resources · 5-8 Phases 1-4 (Sessions 1-56) · 9 Final sessions and exam day · 10 Progress tracker · 11 How to use the Excel workbook

1. The daily 3-hour session

Every session uses the same six blocks, so she never wastes time deciding what to do. On working days, split it: blocks 1-3 before work (1.5 hrs) and blocks 4-6 after work (1.5 hrs).

Block	Time	What she does
1. Warm-up	15 min	10 min typing practice + 5 min revise her spelling/error list
2. Listening	35 min	Practice on screen, answers typed directly, no pausing
3. Reading	40 min	Passage or test on screen, using highlight and flag tools
4. Writing	45 min	Task 1 or Task 2 typed with word count, then AI marking (Prompt 3)
5. Speaking	35 min	Recorded answers, marked by ChatGPT or Gemini (Prompts 1-2)
6. Review	10 min	Add every mistake to the error log; write 3 lessons learned

Weekly rhythm: Sessions 1-6 of each week follow the plan; the 7th session of each week is a full mock or a lighter review. Mock days run longer on Reading and Writing (60 minutes each), so borrow time from the warm-up and review blocks.

2. Computer-delivered IELTS: what changes

The questions, timing, difficulty and scoring are the same as paper. Only the way she answers Listening, Reading and Writing changes. In India, IELTS on paper has been replaced; Speaking is a live interview with a certified examiner, often by video call.

Area	Paper	Computer: what to practise
Listening answers	Write, then 10 min to transfer	Type directly while listening. Only **2 extra minutes** at the end to check. Capitals do not matter.
Moving between boxes	Pen	Press **Tab** or click. The bottom bar shows answered and unanswered questions.
Reading	Underline on paper	**Highlight** and add **notes** on screen; split view, passage left and questions right.
Unsure answers	Circle the question	**Flag for review** and return from the bottom bar.
Writing	Handwriting, count words yourself	Typing with an automatic **word counter**; cut, copy and paste to re-order.
Results	About 13 days	Most computer results within about 2 days.

Shortcuts to practise

Keys	Use
Tab / Shift+Tab	Next / previous answer box (fastest in Listening)
Ctrl+C, Ctrl+X, Ctrl+V	Copy exact words from the Reading passage into answer boxes; re-order Writing
Ctrl+Z	Undo in Writing
Shift+Arrow keys	Select words, then right-click to highlight or add a note

Shortcut availability can vary slightly by test software; confirm on the familiarisation test (FAM).

3. Using ChatGPT and Gemini as her examiner

AI is good at catching repeated words, grammar errors and weak structure, but it is not an official examiner: treat its band as a range, and when ChatGPT and Gemini disagree, trust the lower score.

1. Always paste the same examiner prompt, so scores are comparable day to day.
2. Speaking: use the app's voice mode for the live test, then ask for the transcript and a score. Also record on the phone and replay, because AI judges pronunciation poorly.
3. Never memorise an AI-written answer. Examiners spot memorised answers and lower the score.
4. Once a week, score the same piece in both ChatGPT and Gemini. If the gap is more than 0.5 band, use the lower one.
5. Keep the official band descriptors open (BD-W, BD-S in Section 4).

Prompt 1: live Speaking test (voice mode)

```
Act as a strict, certified IELTS Speaking examiner. Run a full IELTS Speaking test (Part 1: 4-5 min, Part 2: 1 min prep + 2 min talk, Part 3: 4-5 min) on a topic you choose. Ask one question at a time and do not help me or praise me during the test. When it ends, give: (1) a band for Fluency & Coherence, Lexical Resource, Grammatical Range & Accuracy, and Pronunciation using the official public band descriptors; (2) the overall band; (3) every word or phrase I repeated more than 3 times, with counts; (4) my filler words (umm, actually, basically, like) with counts; (5) the 3 most important fixes for Band 7, with one better example sentence each. Be honest; do not inflate the score.
```

Prompt 2: score a recorded answer (paste transcript)

```
Below is the transcript of my IELTS Speaking Part [1/2/3] answer to the question: "[question]". Mark it as a strict IELTS examiner using the official public band descriptors. Give a band for each of the 4 criteria, list repeated words and fillers with counts, mark grammar errors with corrections, and suggest 5 topic words a Band 7-8 speaker would use. Do not rewrite my whole answer. [paste transcript]
```

Prompt 3: Writing marking

```
Act as a strict IELTS Academic Writing examiner. Here is my Task [1/2]. Question: [paste question]. My answer ([word count] words): [paste answer]. Give a band for Task Achievement/Response, Coherence & Cohesion, Lexical Resource and Grammatical Range & Accuracy using the official public band descriptors, with a reason for each. Then list my grammar and spelling errors with corrections, my over-used words, and the 3 changes that would most raise this to Band 7. Do not rewrite the full essay.
```

Prompt 4: weekly progress check

```
Here are my last 7 days of IELTS scores and error notes: [paste]. Tell me my 2 weakest areas, a pattern in my mistakes, and exactly what to practise next week in a 3-hour daily routine.
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Also run each Writing piece through Cambridge's free Write & Improve (W&I) for a second opinion.

4. Websites and resources (codes used in the sessions)

Code	Resource	Use it for	Link
FAM	Computer familiarisation test (British Council) (Free)	The real test-day screen: Listening, Reading, Writing; L and R auto-scored	https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/take-ielts/prepare/free-ielts-english-practice-tests/ielts-on-computer/familiarisation-test
IDP-FAM	Computer familiarisation test (IDP India) (Free)	Second version of the real screen	https://ieltsidpindia.com/information/computer-delivered-ielts-familiarisation-test
BC-L	British Council Academic Listening practice (Free)	Skill practice tests with answers	https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/prepare/ielts-free-practice-mock-tests/academic/listening
BC-R	British Council Academic Reading practice (Free)	Skill practice tests with answers	https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/prepare/ielts-free-practice-mock-tests/academic/reading
BC-W	British Council Academic Writing practice (Free)	Writing tasks and samples	https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/prepare/ielts-free-practice-mock-tests/academic/writing
BC-S	British Council Speaking practice (Free)	Speaking practice by topic	https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/prepare/ielts-free-practice-mock-tests/academic/speaking

Code	Resource	Use it for	Link
IDP-MOCK	IDP India free mock tests (Free)	Full mocks in a test-like environment	https://ieltsidpindia.com/prepare/ielts-mock-tests
IDP-APP	IELTS by IDP app (Free)	Practice tests, typing exercises, vocabulary	https://ieltsidpindia.com/ielts/app
CAM	Cambridge IELTS Academic books 15-20 (Paid)	Real past papers for full mocks (CAM Test N: Book 15 = Tests 1-4, Book 16 = 5-8 ... Book 20 = 21-24)	Bookshops / Amazon
LIZ	IELTS Liz speaking topics (Free)	Current Part 1/2/3 topics and model answers	https://ieltsliz.com/ielts-speaking-topics/
LIZ-P1	IELTS Liz Part 1 topics (Free)	Part 1 questions	https://ieltsliz.com/ielts-speaking-part-1-topics/
LIZ-P2	IELTS Liz Part 2 topics (Free)	Cue cards	https://ieltsliz.com/ielts-speaking-part-2-topics/
IDP-W1	IDP Task 1 sample answers (Free)	Model Task 1 writing	https://ieltsidpindia.com/blog/ielts-writing-task-1-sample-answer
IDP-W2	IDP Task 2 sample answers (Free)	Model Task 2 writing	https://ieltsidpindia.com/blog/ielts-writing-task-2-sample-questions-answers
IDP-V	IDP vocabulary words (Free)	Daily 5-minute word study	https://ieltsidpindia.com/prepare/vocabulary-words-for-ielts
IDP-G	IDP grammar (Free)	Grammar revision	https://ieltsidpindia.com/prepare/grammar
BD-W	Official Writing band descriptors (Free)	What Band 7 means in Writing	https://ielts.org/cdn/ielts-downloadable-assets/ielts-guidance-and-support/ielts-guides/ielts-writing-band-descriptors.pdf
BD-S	Official Speaking band descriptors (Free)	What Band 7 means in Speaking	https://ielts.org/cdn/ielts-downloadable-assets/ielts-guidance-and-support/ielts-guides/ielts-speaking-band-descriptors.pdf
W&I	Write & Improve (Cambridge) (Free)	Instant grammar and vocabulary feedback	https://writeandimprove.com/free
BBC	BBC Learning English (6 Minute English) (Free)	Listening and shadowing	https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish
TYPE	Monkeytype / Keybr (Free)	10 min daily typing	https://monkeytype.com
OSR	IELTS One Skill Retake (Paid)	Backup: retake one skill within 60 days	https://ielts.org/take-a-test/booking-your-test/one-skill-retake

Use official sources (British Council, IDP, ielts.org, Cambridge) for all mock tests; many unofficial sites are easier than the real test.

5. Phase 1 (Sessions 1-14): computer comfort and baseline

By Session 14 typing answers while listening should feel as natural as writing on paper, and she knows her starting band in all four skills.

Study notes for this phase

- **Typing while listening:** read ahead and predict the answer type (number, name, plural noun). If she misses part of a word, type the first 3-4 letters and keep listening; complete it in the 2-minute check. Never stop listening to fix spelling.
- **Move with Tab**, not the mouse. Capitals do not matter, so skip Shift. Type numbers as digits ('15').
- **Screen tools:** highlight key words in Reading, add notes, and flag questions to return to. Copy-paste exact words from the passage into answer boxes.
- **Spelling list:** accommodation, environment, government, library, February, Wednesday, necessary, business, restaurant, temperature, questionnaire, recommend, committee, equipment, available, approximately, convenient, opportunity, colleague, knowledge.
- **Speaking habit:** every Part 1 answer = answer + reason + example (2-3 sentences).

Sessions

#	Date	Focus	Listening (35m)	Reading (40m)	Writing (45m)	Speaking with AI (35m)	Done
1	Thu 15 Oct	**MOCK 1: baseline**	FAM full Listening, typed	FAM full Reading (60m, borrow from Writing)	FAM Writing T1+T2 (60m), AI Prompt 3	AI Prompt 1 full test; note band + filler counts	
2	Fri 16 Oct	**Screen tools**	BC-L Section 1; practise Tab between boxes	BC-R: highlight, notes, flag on 1 passage	Learn T1 structure: intro, overview, 2 body paras	Part 1 Home + Hometown (LIZ Part 1), Prompt 2	
3	Sat 17 Oct	**Type and listen**	CAM Test 1 Sec 1+2, typed into a laptop document	TFNG passage, 20m	T2 opinion essay, plan 5m + type 35m, Prompt 3	Part 1 Work + Free time; record and replay	
4	Sun 18 Oct	**Spelling traps**	CAM Test 1 Sec 3+4; add every misspelling to error log	Matching headings passage	T1 line graph (BC-W), aim 170-190 words	Part 2: describe a person (LIZ Part 2), 1m notes + 2m talk	
5	Mon 19 Oct	**Paraphrase**	IDP-FAM Listening, focus on synonyms	Sentence + summary completion	T2 discuss both views	Part 2: describe a place; Prompt 2 counts repeated words	
6	Tue 20 Oct	**Writing on screen**	CAM Test 2 Sec 1+2	Multiple choice passage	T1 table; watch word counter	Part 3: 'Why do you think...?' opinion + reason + example	
7	Wed 21 Oct	**Light review**	Redo all wrong Listening answers with transcript	Re-read hard TFNG questions	Rewrite Session 1 essay using AI feedback	BBC 6 Minute English: shadow 15m	
8	Thu 22 Oct	**Listening accuracy**	CAM Test 2 full, no pause	Matching information passage	T2 problem-solution	Part 1 x 8 questions, Prompt 2	
9	Fri 23 Oct	**Reading speed**	CAM Test 2 Sec 3+4	Full Reading, skim 2m per passage	T1 bar chart	Part 2: an object you use; Prompt 2	
10	Sat 24 Oct	**Distractors**	BC-L full; mark where speakers change their mind	TFNG + Yes/No/Not Given	T2 advantages/disadvantages	Part 3: Education + Technology	
11	Sun 25 Oct	**Task 1 overview**	CAM Test 3 Sec 1+2	Headings + paragraph matching	T1 pie charts; overview with no numbers	Full speaking test, Prompt 1 (voice)	
12	Mon 26 Oct	**Fillers**	CAM Test 3 Sec 3+4	Summary completion with word box	T2 two-part question	Part 1+2: replace top 3 repeated words (from AI counts)	
13	Tue 27 Oct	**Vocabulary**	IDP-MOCK Listening section	Full Reading 60m	T1 process diagram; IDP-V 10 topic words	Part 3: Environment + Work	
14	Wed 28 Oct	**MOCK 2**	IDP-MOCK or CAM Test 4 full Listening, typed	Full Reading 60m	Full Writing T1+T2, 60m, Prompt 3 in both AIs	Prompt 1 full test in ChatGPT and Gemini	

Green = full mock test. Blue = light review.

6. Phase 2 (Sessions 15-28): build each skill to Band 7

This phase fixes the Writing templates and Reading question-type methods, and starts full voice speaking tests every few days.

Study notes for this phase

- **Task 1 template (170-190 words, 20 min):** intro paraphrases the question; overview gives the 2 biggest trends with no numbers ('Overall, ... while ...'); Body 1 and Body 2 group and compare data with key figures. No opinion, no conclusion.
- **Task 2 template (260-290 words, 40 min):** intro = paraphrase + clear position answering every part; 2 body paragraphs using Point, Explain, Example, Link; conclusion restates the position. Leave 4 minutes to proofread articles, plurals, verb agreement.
- **Band 7 in Writing** (official descriptors): clear overview of key trends (T1), clear developed position (T2), some less common words and collocations, a variety of complex structures, frequent error-free sentences.
- **Reading:** False = the passage says the opposite; Not Given = it says nothing. Most question types follow passage order (not headings or matching information). Never leave a blank: guess and flag.
- **Stalling phrases** instead of 'umm': 'That's an interesting question...', 'Let me think about that for a moment...', 'I've never really thought about it, but...'.

Sessions

#	Date	Focus	Listening (35m)	Reading (40m)	Writing (45m)	Speaking with AI (35m)	Done
15	Thu 29 Oct	**Weakest skill from Mock 2**	CAM Test 4 Sec 1+2	Weakest question type x 2 passages	Rewrite weakest Mock 2 task	Part 2: a skill you learned	
16	Fri 30 Oct	**T2 structure**	CAM Test 4 Sec 3+4	TFNG x 2	T2 opinion using the template, Prompt 3	Part 1 quick-fire: 15 questions in 5 min	
17	Sat 31 Oct	**T1 accuracy**	BC-L full	Full Reading 60m	T1 line graph with future data	Part 3: Society + Health	
18	Sun 01 Nov	**Collocations**	CAM Test 5 Sec 1+2	Matching features + sentence endings	T2 discuss both views; W&I check	Part 2: a time you helped someone	
19	Mon 02 Nov	**Speaking fluency**	CAM Test 5 Sec 3+4	Passage 3 only x 2 (hardest)	T1 map (before/after)	Full test Prompt 1 (voice); compare filler count with Session 1	
20	Tue 03 Nov	**Complex sentences**	IDP-FAM Listening again, aim 32+	MCQ + summary completion	T2: 2 complex sentences in every paragraph	Part 3: Work abroad + Technology	
21	Wed 04 Nov	**MOCK 3**	CAM Test 6 full Listening	CAM Test 6 full Reading	Full Writing 60m, Prompt 3	Prompt 1 full test	
22	Thu 05 Nov	**Fix Mock 3 errors**	Redo wrong Mock 3 questions	Weakest question type	T2 problem-solution	Part 2: a challenge you faced	
23	Fri 06 Nov	**Spelling and plurals**	CAM Test 7 Sec 1+2; focus on plural 's'	Headings x 2	T1 mixed (2 charts)	Part 1 Work/Study, deeper answers	
24	Sat 07 Nov	**Paraphrasing**	CAM Test 7 Sec 3+4	Full Reading 60m	T2 two-part question	Part 3: Education	
25	Sun 08 Nov	**Timing**	BC-L full, no pause	Passage 2+3 in 40m	T1 process; finish in 20m exactly	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
26	Mon 09 Nov	**Pronunciation**	CAM Test 8 Sec 1+2	TFNG + headings	T2 advantages/disadvantages	BBC shadowing 15m + Part 2 recorded	
27	Tue 10 Nov	**Linkers**	CAM Test 8 Sec 3+4	Matching information	T1 table; vary linkers (whereas, by contrast)	Part 3: Environment + Cities	
28	Wed 11 Nov	**MOCK 4**	IDP-MOCK full Listening	Full Reading	Full Writing 60m, both AIs	Prompt 1 full test in both AIs	

Green = full mock test. Blue = light review.

7. Phase 3 (Sessions 29-42): timed accuracy and the weakest skill

Everything is now timed like the real exam, and 2 of every 7 sessions go to whichever skill scored lowest in the last mock.

Study notes for this phase

- **Reading time plan:** Passage 1 = 17 min, Passage 2 = 20 min, Passage 3 = 23 min. Stuck more than 90 seconds: guess, flag, move on.
- **Listening 2-minute check:** only finish half-typed words, fix spellings and check word limits; never rethink answers.
- **Fixing repeated words:** take the AI's top 3 repeated words and learn 3 replacements each: very good -> excellent / really impressive; I think -> In my view / I'd say; also -> on top of that / as well as.
- **Controlling stress:** box breathing before Part 2 and before each mock (in 4 sec, hold 4, out 4, hold 4, x4). Lost a word: describe it ('the thing you use to...'). 'Could you repeat the question, please?' is allowed.
- **Part 3 shape:** opinion + reason + example + the other side ('It depends... On the one hand... but...').

Sessions

#	Date	Focus	Listening (35m)	Reading (40m)	Writing (45m)	Speaking with AI (35m)	Done
29	Thu 12 Nov	**Weakest skill (from Mock 4)**	CAM Test 9 full	Weakest type x 2	Rewrite weakest Mock 4 task	Part 2: a book or film	
30	Fri 13 Nov	**Listening Sec 4**	CAM Test 9 Sec 4 + CAM Test 10 Sec 4	Passage 3 x 2	T2 opinion in 40m, 270 words	Part 1 quick-fire 15 questions	
31	Sat 14 Nov	**T1 Band 7 overview**	CAM Test 10 Sec 1-3	Full Reading 60m (17/20/23)	T1 two charts	Part 3: Advertising + Culture	
32	Sun 15 Nov	**Grammar range**	BC-L full	TFNG + MCQ	T2 with conditionals, relative clauses, passive	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
33	Mon 16 Nov	**Weakest skill**	Weakest section type x 3	Weakest type x 2	T1 process	Part 2 x 3 cue cards back-to-back (LIZ)	
34	Tue 17 Nov	**Stress control**	CAM Test 11 full, no pause	Full Reading 60m	T2 hardest topic (crime, government)	Box breathing, then full test Prompt 1	
35	Wed 18 Nov	**MOCK 5**	CAM Test 12 full	CAM Test 12 full Reading	Full Writing 60m, both AIs	Prompt 1 in both AIs; Prompt 4 weekly check	
36	Thu 19 Nov	**Fix Mock 5 errors**	Redo wrong questions	Weakest type	Rewrite weakest Mock 5 task	Part 2: an achievement you are proud of	
37	Fri 20 Nov	**Maps and plans**	CAM Test 13 Sec 1+2 (maps)	Headings + matching	T1 map	Part 3: Health + Family	
38	Sat 21 Nov	**Speed**	CAM Test 13 Sec 3+4	Full Reading in 55m (5m buffer)	T2 in 37m + 3m proofread	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
39	Sun 22 Nov	**Weakest skill**	Weakest section type x 3	Passage 3 x 2	T2 two-part question	Part 1 deeper answers on 10 LIZ topics	
40	Mon 23 Nov	**Vocabulary by topic**	CAM Test 14 Sec 1+2	MCQ + summary	T1 table; IDP-V 15 topic words	Part 3: Technology + Work	
41	Tue 24 Nov	**Light review**	Replay only wrong answers from Mocks 3-5	Re-read error log	Read IDP-W Band 8-9 samples	BBC shadowing 15m	
42	Wed 25 Nov	**MOCK 6**	CAM Test 15 full	CAM Test 15 full Reading	Full Writing 60m, both AIs	Prompt 1 in both AIs	

Green = full mock test. Blue = light review.

8. Phase 4 (Sessions 43-56): full mocks and polish

The goal is two mocks in a row at 7.0 or above, done at the same time of day as the real exam.

Study notes for this phase

- **No new methods now.** Repeat what works and remove the mistakes in the error log.
- **Writing order:** test T1 first (Mock 7) vs T2 first (Mock 8) and keep the order that scores higher. T2 is worth twice as much as T1.
- **Computer advantage:** type body paragraphs first, then the introduction, and move it to the top with cut and paste.
- **Speaking:** no memorised answers. Practise new questions each day so answers stay natural.
- **One Skill Retake (backup):** if she gets 7 overall but one skill is short, she can retake only that skill within 60 days of a computer test, at centres that offer it. Check the employer or regulator accepts it first.

Sessions

#	Date	Focus	Listening (35m)	Reading (40m)	Writing (45m)	Speaking with AI (35m)	Done
43	Thu 26 Nov	**Fix Mock 6 errors**	Redo wrong questions	Weakest type x 2	Rewrite weakest Mock 6 task	Part 2 x 2 new cue cards (LIZ)	
44	Fri 27 Nov	**Listening polish**	CAM Test 16 full	Passage 2+3	T2 hardest topic	Part 3: abstract topics	
45	Sat 28 Nov	**Reading polish**	CAM Test 17 Sec 3+4	CAM Test 17 full Reading 60m	T1 mixed chart	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
46	Sun 29 Nov	**Writing polish**	BC-L full	TFNG + headings	T2 + rewrite intro/conclusion of 3 old essays	Part 1 + 3 with natural linkers	
47	Mon 30 Nov	**Weakest skill**	Weakest section type x 3	Weakest type x 2	Weakest task type	Part 2 x 3 back-to-back	
48	Tue 01 Dec	**Speed + check routine**	CAM Test 18 full; 2-min check only for spelling	Full Reading in 55m	T1 in 18m + 2m proofread	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
49	Wed 02 Dec	**MOCK 7 (exam time of day, T1 first)**	CAM Test 19 full	CAM Test 19 full Reading	Full Writing 60m, both AIs	Prompt 1 in both AIs; Prompt 4 weekly check	
50	Thu 03 Dec	**Fix Mock 7 errors**	Redo wrong questions	Weakest type	Rewrite weakest task	Part 2: a goal for the future	
51	Fri 04 Dec	**Confidence**	IDP-MOCK Listening	Passage 3 x 2	T2 opinion	Part 3: Work abroad (her real interview topic)	
52	Sat 05 Dec	**Final weak spots**	CAM Test 20 Sec 1-3	Full Reading 60m	T1 process + T2 outline only	Full test Prompt 1 (voice)	
53	Sun 06 Dec	**Light**	BBC 6 Minute English	1 passage	Read own 3 best essays	Part 1 warm-up only	
54	Mon 07 Dec	**MOCK 8 (exam time of day, T2 first)**	CAM Test 21 full	CAM Test 21 full Reading	Full Writing 60m, both AIs	Prompt 1 in both AIs	
55	Tue 08 Dec	**Fix Mock 8 errors**	Redo wrong questions only	Redo wrong questions only	Fix grammar errors from Mock 8	Part 2 x 2	
56	Wed 09 Dec	**Light review**	IDP-FAM Listening (screen refresh)	IDP-FAM Reading	Review templates	BBC shadowing 15m	

Green = full mock test. Blue = light review.

9. Final sessions (57-60) and exam day

The last four sessions are short on purpose: she arrives rested, with the screen routine automatic.

#	Date	Plan	Done
57	Thu 10 Dec	1 Listening section + 1 Reading passage on the FAM screen; review error log; 1 Part 2 with AI	
58	Fri 11 Dec	Read own best essays and templates; Part 1 warm-up 10 min; check test centre route and timing	
59	Sat 12 Dec	Light: an English podcast for fun; prepare ID (the same one used to book); sleep early	
60	Sun 13 Dec	Rest. 5-minute Part 1 warm-up only	

Exam-day checklist

- [ ] ID used at booking, test confirmation; arrive at the time the centre gave
- [ ] Sound check: raise a hand at once if the headphones or volume are wrong
- [ ] Listening: use the reading-ahead pauses fully; type short and fix in the 2-minute check
- [ ] Reading: 17 / 20 / 23 minutes; flag and move on after 90 seconds; no blanks
- [ ] Writing: watch the word counter (150+ and 250+); 3-4 minutes to proofread
- [ ] Speaking: box breathing before entering; answer + reason + example; ask to repeat if unsure
- [ ] If one section goes badly, reset with 3 slow breaths; each section is marked separately

10. Progress tracker

Fill a row after each mock (or use the Mock Score Tracker sheet, which calculates bands automatically). Overall band = average of the four skills rounded to the nearest 0.5. For Speaking and Writing, enter the lower of the ChatGPT and Gemini scores.

Mock	Session	Date	Listening /40	Reading /40	Writing (AI)	Speaking (AI)	Overall	Weakest
1	1	Thu 15 Oct						
2	14	Wed 28 Oct						
3	21	Wed 04 Nov						
4	28	Wed 11 Nov						
5	35	Wed 18 Nov						
6	42	Wed 25 Nov						
7	49	Wed 02 Dec						
8	54	Mon 07 Dec						

Raw score to band (approximate; official tables vary slightly per test)

Correct /40	39-40	37-38	35-36	32-34	30-31	26-29	23-25	18-22
Listening band	9	8.5	8	7.5	7	6.5	6	5.5

Correct /40	39-40	37-38	35-36	33-34	30-32	27-29	23-26	19-22
Academic Reading band	9	8.5	8	7.5	7	6.5	6	5.5

Band 7 needs about 30 correct in both Listening and Reading.

Format facts from British Council, IDP and ielts.org pages checked on 14 Oct 2026; confirm the latest rules with your test centre.

11. How to use the Excel workbook (IELTS_60_Day_Plan.xlsx)

The workbook needs about 5 minutes of typing a day: she fills the yellow cells, and every band, date and total calculates itself.

Set-up: do this once before Session 1

Cell (Start Here tab)	What to type	Example
B4 Plan start date	The day she does Session 1	15-Oct-2026
B5 Exam date	The date on her booking confirmation	16-Dec-2026
B7 Target overall band	Her required overall band	7

Then clear the made-up example numbers in row 5 of **Mock Score Tracker** (D5, F5, H5, I5, K5, L5), row 5 of **Speaking AI Log** (C5 to M5, except J5) and row 5 of **Error Log**: select the cells and press Delete (not the whole row). To fill it on a phone, upload it to Google Drive and open with Google Sheets.

Colour code

Colour	Meaning	What to do
Yellow fill, blue text	Input cell	Type here
White cell with a calculated value	Formula (dates, bands, overall)	Leave alone
Green row	Full mock test session	Do the full test; fill the Mock Score Tracker after
Light blue row	Light or rest session	Shorter session; still mark Done
Green / red in Done or Overall	Auto-colour (Yes or on target = green)	Nothing; it colours itself

Sheet by sheet: what to fill

Tab	What it is for	She fills	Calculates itself	How often
Start Here	Dates, target, routine, AI rules	B4 start date, B5 exam date, B7 target	B6 days left, B8 sessions completed	Once
60-Day Plan	Task list for every session	I: today's AI band; J: Done (pick Yes / Partly / No); K: notes or 3 lessons	B: dates	Every session
AI Prompts	4 prompts for ChatGPT / Gemini	Nothing	-	When needed
Resources	Codes in the plan with clickable links	Nothing	-	When needed
Speaking AI Log	Daily speaking scores from the AI	C: AI used (pick); D: Part; E: topic; F-I: Fluency, Vocabulary, Grammar, Pronunciation; K: filler count; L: top repeated words; M: fix for tomorrow	B: date; J: AI overall; K67: filler trend	Every session
Mock Score Tracker	Results of the 8 full mocks	D: Listening correct /40; F: Reading correct /40; H, I: Writing band from ChatGPT, Gemini; K, L: Speaking band from ChatGPT, Gemini	L and R bands, Writing/Speaking used (lower AI score), Overall, Gap, Weakest skill	After Sessions 1, 14, 21, 28, 35, 42, 49, 54
Band Conversion	Raw score to band table	Nothing	-	Reference
Error Log	Every wrong answer and misspelling	A date; B skill; C question type; D her answer; E correct answer; F why wrong; G Fixed?	-	Every session

Where the numbers come from

- **Listening and Reading correct /40:** the score at the end of the familiarisation test, or her own count with the Cambridge answer key.
- **Writing and Speaking bands:** the overall band ChatGPT or Gemini gives after Prompt 3 (Writing) or Prompt 1 (Speaking). Type the number only, e.g. 6.5. If the AI gives a range like 6-6.5, type the lower number.
- **Speaking criteria (F-I) and filler count (K):** the four bands and the umm/actually/basically/like total the AI lists at the end of Prompt 1 or 2.

Filling routine

When	Steps
Every session (Review block, 5 min)	1. Error Log: one row per wrong answer or misspelling. 2. Speaking AI Log: AI's 4 scores, fillers, repeated words, one fix. 3. 60-Day Plan: AI band (I), Done (J), 3 lessons (K).
Mock days (green rows, 10 min)	The 3 daily steps, then fill the mock's row in Mock Score Tracker. The Weakest skill column shows what gets extra time in the next 6 sessions.
Once a week (after Sessions 7, 14, 21...)	Check Start Here B8 and B6. Check the filler trend (Speaking AI Log K67; positive = improving). Paste the week's Speaking and Error Log rows into ChatGPT with Prompt 4. Re-test Error Log rows marked No and change them to Yes when right.

Worked example: Mock 1

She types (Mock Score Tracker)	Value	Workbook shows
D Listening correct	27	E Listening band 6.5
F Reading correct	25	G Reading band 6.0
H Writing ChatGPT / I Writing Gemini	6.5 / 6	J Writing used 6.0 (the lower)
K Speaking ChatGPT / L Speaking Gemini	6.5 / 6	M Speaking used 6.0 (the lower)
-	-	N Overall 6.0, O Gap -1.0 (red), P Weakest: Reading

When two skills tie for lowest, Weakest skill names the first in the order Listening, Reading, Writing, Speaking.

Common problems and fixes

Problem	Fix
A date shows as a number like 46310	Select the cell, then Format > Number > Date
A band or overall cell is blank	It waits until all its inputs are filled (Overall needs all 4 skills)
A formula was typed over	Press Ctrl+Z, or copy the same cell from the row above and paste it
AI gave no score for one criterion	Ask: 'Give a band for each of the 4 criteria' and type those
Missed a day	Leave that row's Done empty; do the next session tomorrow and skip one light session later
Exam date changed	Change Start Here B5 only; days left updates by itself